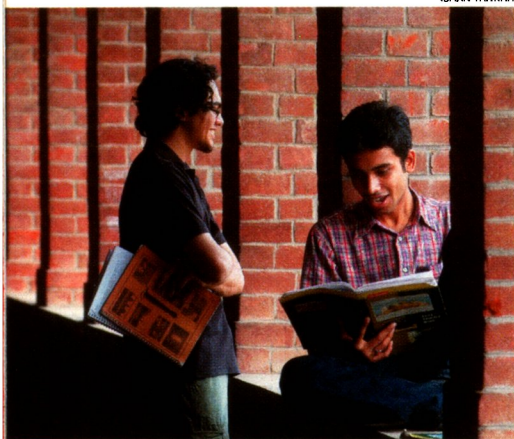


college offers post-graduation and research opportunities like M.Phil and Ph.D in all the arts subjects, except Tamil literature.

The arts department of the college has a long history of nurturing and producing great sports persons. In January this year, it won the 17th state-level inter-collegiate football tournament for the second time in a row. The following month, the Loyola hockey team won the first South India inter-collegiate hockey tournament held in Chennai, beating St. Joseph's College of Commerce, Bangalore. Such individual tournaments apart, Loyola students form almost two-thirds of the

CLASS APART: St. Stephen's grooms students to become entrepreneurs

ISHAN TANKHA



Madras University's sports team.

With such a firm grounding, many Loyola students flourish in the civil service examinations. The arts department has also been a feeding point for many prestigious universities, both within and outside the country. The alumni list of the college is very impressive as it includes names like those of Union Finance Minister P. Chidambaram, former President R. Venkatraman, former Union minister Dayanidhi Maran, TVS honcho Venu Srinivasan, tennis players Vijay Amritraj and Ramesh Krishnan, hockey player Vasudevan Baskaran and Kollywood actors like Vijay, Vikram and Surya.

Meanwhile, Xavierites from Mumbai, which has secured the second place in the arts stream, have also been making their presence felt. "You gave me wings...and it's those wings

CITY-WISE RANKING

DELHI

1. St. Stephen's College
2. Lady Shriram College
3. Hindu College
4. Miranda House
5. Hansraj College
6. Jesus & Mary College
7. Sri Venkateswara College
8. Gargi College
9. Kamala Nehru College for Women
10. Indraprastha College

CHENNAI

1. Loyola College
2. Madras Christian College
3. Stella Maris College
4. Presidency College
5. Women's Christian College
6. Ethiraj College for Women
7. Vivekananda College
8. DG Vaishnav College
9. MOP Vaishnav College for Women
10. Meenakshi College for Women

BANGALORE

1. Christ College
2. Mount Carmel College
3. St. Joseph's College
4. Jyoti Nivas College
5. Maharani Arts College
6. SB Mahaveer Jain College
7. National College, Jayanagar
8. NMKV College for Women
9. MES College
10. National College, Basavangudi

AHMEDABAD

1. St. Xavier's College
2. H.K. Arts College
3. Smt. Laxmiben & Shri Chimanlal Mehta Arts College
4. C.U. Shah Arts College
5. L.D. Arts College

LUCKNOW

1. Isabella Thoburn
2. Avadh Girls Degree
3. Shia Degree College
4. Mahila Vidyalaya College
5. Lucknow Christian Degree College

CHANDIGARH

1. MCM DAV College for Women
2. Govt. College for Girls
3. Govt. College for Boys
4. D.A.V. College
5. Shri Guru Govind Singh College

PUNE

1. Fergusson College
2. Symbiosis Society's College of Arts & Commerce
3. St. Mira's College
4. Nowrojee Wadia College
5. Modern College

ARTS

MUMBAI

1. St. Xavier's College
2. Elphinstone College
3. Sophia College for Women
4. Ramnarain Ruia College
5. Mithibai College of Arts
6. KJ Somaiya College
7. Vinayak Ganesh Vaze College of Arts
8. SIES's College of Arts, Science & Commerce
9. DG Ruparel College
10. Jai Hind College

KOLKATA

1. Presidency College
2. St. Xavier's College
3. Loreto College
4. Faculty of Arts, Jadavpur University
5. Scottish Church College
6. Bethune College
7. Lady Brabourne College
8. Shri Shikshayatan
9. Gokhale Memorial Girls College
10. Asutosh College

HYDERABAD

1. University College for Women, Osmania Univ
2. Nizam's College
3. Loyola Academy College
4. Kasturba Gandhi Degree & PG College for Women
5. AV College of Arts, Science & Commerce
6. RBVRR Women's College
7. St. Ann's Degree College for Women
8. Badruka College of Commerce & Arts
9. Shadan College for Women
10. Anwar Ul Uloom College

KOCHI

1. Sacred Heart College
2. St. Teresa's College
3. Bharat Mata College
4. St. Albert's College
5. Maharaja's College

JAIPUR

1. Int'l College for Girls
2. Kanoria Mahila Mahavidyalaya
3. Shri Veer Balika College
4. Shri Satya Sai College for Women
5. Rajasthan College

City-level ranking of a college is determined by its scores in the Top 50 national ranking. For those city colleges that do not figure in the toppers' list, only perceptual scores were considered for the above ranking.

that will always help me fly back to you," says a quote on a students' blog, summing up what these students feel about their alma mater.

Apart from preparing students to top merit lists, the college is also striving to give them international exposure. The council of international programmes at Xavier's is active in arranging exchange modules for students. In March 2007, under the Harvard College in Asia project, 10 students attended a week-long conference at the Harvard University. This year, the college will host students from St. Mary's University, Texas, for a course in Indian culture, history, philosophy, economics and business. "We focus on the overall development of the student," says Principal Father Frazer Mascarenhas, adding that sports, music and voluntary social programmes are very much a part of the college activities. Malhar, the

annual college fest, amply reflects it.

Similarly, St. Stephen's, at third position, continues to make strides with its students proving to be a class apart. As Tavleen Bhatia, a third-year student of economics at Stephen's, says, "We are taught to think like entrepreneurs and not expected to cram theories." Of course, excellent faculty and some great pedagogic tools like business games, mock stock transactions and consultancies help the college in its pursuit for excellence.

St. Stephen's honours programmes in English and economics are the most coveted in the Delhi University. The cut-off marks are very high and one has to sit through a tough interview. Little wonder then that global organisations like Goldman Sachs and Magsaysay, looking for collaborators, zero in on St. Stephen's. And seldom are they disappointed.

with Aditi Pai